9 File and Storage Management

9.1 Introduction

File handling is a crucial aspect of web applications, especially when dealing with user-generated content. Laravel provides a powerful and flexible file storage system that allows developers to easily manage files across different storage systems, including local disks and cloud services like Amazon S3.

This chapter will cover the basics of file handling in Laravel, including how to upload, retrieve, and delete files. We will also explore the differences between public and private storage, and how to work with remote disks.

9.2 Configuration

Laravel's filesystem configuration is located in `config/filesystems.php`. By default, Laravel uses the local disk for file storage, but you can easily configure it to use other disks like Amazon S3 or Google Cloud Storage.

Environment variables are used to set up the filesystem configuration. For example, you can set the default disk in your `.env` file:

```
FILESYSTEM_DISK=local
```

9.3 Storing Files

In this section, we will cover how to store files in Laravel. We will discuss the different storage disks available and how to configure them.

We will also explore how to upload files using forms and handle file uploads in controllers.

9.3.1 Uploading via Form

We will create a controller method to handle file uploads. Here's an example of how to do this: